



Relentless raid: Arjun Deshwal's career-best performance lit up Chennai, even as fans wondered if the Thalaivas' surge had come too late. PKL MEDIA

A CITY THAT LIVES ITS KABADDI, POINT BY POINT

Sportstar's team on the ground brings you the sights, sounds and stories of Chennai's kabaddi fever — a **celebration** that thrives both on and off the mat.

Tamil Thalaivas wrapped up its home leg with a commanding 57-37 win over the Patna Pirates, the team's first 50-plus score of the season, led by skipper Arjun Deshwal's career-best 26 raid points.

After the customary post-match

press conferences, the Diary stepped out to catch the cab waiting at the gate. As it got in, the driver, Kavi Chakravarthi, was glued to his phone, with match highlights playing on a screen clipped precariously above the steering wheel.

His hands stayed steady on the wheel, but his eyes followed every

frame of the replays. A lifelong Thalaivas supporter, Kavi traced his allegiance back to watching with school friends in Coimbatore when the team debuted in 2017.

"I hail from Coimbatore, and we watch the PKL without fail. We try not to miss Tamil Thalaivas' games, especially since they're based out of